

Uranus and Neptune

These two “ice giants” are so far away that you need powerful telescopes to see them. We have learned most of what we know about them from the space probe *Voyager 2*. Both planets are made mostly of gas and ice and are very cold.

Side spin

Uranus's outer layers are made mostly of hydrogen and helium gas. Another gas, called methane, gives the planet its blue-green color. Uranus spins on its side as it orbits the Sun. A system of rings and 27 moons orbit around Uranus's middle.

Uranus's “ring” is made up of 13 separate rings of dark rock.



Voyager 2 sent thousands of pictures back to Earth.

Uranus's summer lasts for 42 years! However, summer on Uranus is very cold.

A long journey

Voyager 2 left Earth in 1977 to travel to the distant giants of the Solar System. After visiting Jupiter and Saturn, it reached Uranus in 1986 and Neptune in 1989.